

Diploma in Leadership & Management

Build your resilience



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Lesson outcomes

The student will be able to understand the fundamentals of upskilling and reskilling. Students will also receive essential information regarding active listening and running effective meetings as part of the skills for this lesson.

Introduction

It's all about the skills, we've covered competencies in module 1 and now we're going to look at skills and upskilling. This lesson will also focus on active listening and running an effective meetings skill.

Key reading materials:

<https://www.westvalley.com/resources/employer-resources/top-five-best-stress-management-tips-for-managers>

What is resilience?

According to (APA, n.d.)

Life may not come with a map, but everyone will experience twists and turns, from everyday challenges to traumatic events with more lasting impact, like the death of a loved one, a life-altering accident or a serious illness. Each change affects people differently, bringing a unique flood of thoughts, strong emotions and uncertainty. Yet people generally adapt well over time to life-changing situations and stressful situations — in part thanks to resilience.

Psychologists define resilience as the process of adapting well in the face of adversity, trauma, tragedy, threats or significant sources of stress — such as family and relationship problems, serious health problems, or workplace and financial stressors. As much as resilience involves "bouncing back" from these difficult experiences, it can also involve profound personal growth.

While these adverse events, much like rough river waters, are certainly painful and difficult, they don't have to determine the outcome of your life. There are many aspects of your life you can control, modify and grow with. That's the role of resilience. Becoming more resilient not only helps you get through difficult circumstances, it also empowers you to grow and even improve your life along the way.

What resilience isn't

Being resilient doesn't mean that a person won't experience difficulty or distress. People who have suffered major adversity or trauma in their lives commonly experience emotional pain and stress. In fact, the road to resilience is likely to involve considerable emotional distress.

While certain factors might make some individuals more resilient than others, resilience isn't necessarily a personality trait that only some people possess. On the contrary, resilience involves behaviors, thoughts and actions that anyone can learn and develop. The ability to learn resilience is one reason research has shown that resilience is ordinary, not extraordinary. One example is the response of many Americans to the Sept. 11, 2001 terrorist attacks and individuals' efforts to rebuild their lives after tragedy.

Like building a muscle, increasing your resilience takes time and intentionality. Focusing on four core components — connection, wellness, healthy thinking and meaning — can empower you to withstand and learn from difficult and traumatic experiences. To increase your capacity for resilience to weather — and grow from — the difficulties, use these strategies.

What Are the 7 Cs of Resilience?

Pediatrician Ken Ginsburg, MD, who specializes in adolescent medicine at the Children's Hospital of Philadelphia, developed the 7 Cs model of resilience to help kids and teens build the skills to be happier and more resilient.

- The 7 Cs model is centered around two key points:
- Young people live up or down to the expectations that are set for them and need adults who love them unconditionally and hold them to high expectations.
- How we model resilience for young people is far more important than what we say about it.
- The American Academy of Pediatrics summarizes the 7 Cs as follows:
- **Competence** This is the ability to know how to handle situations effectively. To build competence, individuals develop a set of skills to help them trust their judgments and make responsible choices.
- **Confidence** Dr. Ginsburg says that true self-confidence is rooted in competence. Individuals gain confidence by demonstrating competence in real-life situations.
- **Connection** Close ties to family, friends, and community provide a sense of security and belonging.
- **Character** Individuals need a fundamental sense of right and wrong to make responsible choices, contribute to society, and experience self-worth.
- **Contribution** Ginsburg says that having a sense of purpose is a powerful motivator. Contributing to one's community reinforces positive reciprocal relationships.
- **Coping** When people learn to cope with stress effectively, they are better prepared to handle adversity and setbacks.
- **Control** Developing an understanding of internal control helps individuals act as problem-solvers instead of victims of circumstance. When individuals learn that they can control the outcomes of their decisions, they are more likely to view themselves as capable and confident.

Resilience Building Plan Worksheet

This worksheet is provided by (AcpOnline , n.d.)

Create a plan for yourself and practice these skills. Be open to not doing all of them perfectly and curious about what you are going to learn about yourself and others in the process.

1. Recognize Your Signs of Stress

- a) Where you feel in your body?
- b) What is your "bad habit" when stressed?

2. Build Physical Hardiness

- a) **Make small changes to improve health (better sleep, nutrition, hydration, exercise) and be accountable to someone**

i. One change I would like to make: _____ Who I'll tell about it: _____

Strengthen Relaxation Response—"calm body/calm mind"

- a) Activities at home that help me relax:
- b) Activities at work that help me relax:
- c) Try out relaxation strategies and ways to be more present:
 - i. mindfulness meditation (see apps like www.calm.com, www.headspace.com)
 - ii. self-soothe by doing something comforting related to 1 of the 5 senses
 - 1. Tactile (hold something soft/comforting/grounding)
 - 2. Smell (lavender, fresh air)
 - 3. Visual (puppy photos, look out window at trees)

- 4. Auditory (music, sounds of nature)
- 5. Taste (tea, chocolate)

4. Use Your Strengths: Describe a time that you were able to overcome or handle a major challenge in your life.

- a) What did you learn about yourself?
- b) b. What personal strength(s) did you draw upon?
- c) Draw an image of when you are your most resilient.
- d) How might you apply this strength now?

5. Increase Positive Emotions on Daily Basis

- a) Sources of joy, humor
- b) Gratitude visit or letter
- c) Accomplishments

6. Increase Positive Emotions on Daily Basis

- a) Notice regularly what happened in your day that was meaningful What are those activities/moments?
- b) Activities associated with “flow”

7. Counter Unhelpful Thinking

- a) Write down what you are thinking about when stressed and then ask: What is the worst that could happen AND could I survive it? Best that could happen? Most likely? What would I tell a friend in similar situation?
- b) If you can't stop thinking about a situation, write about it a couple of times over 4 weeks (for about 15 minutes each time) and see how your story changes/becomes clearer.
- c) If you are being hard on yourself, practice self-compassion (see www.selfcompassionquiz.com)
- d) Remember what a hero/coach/mentor said to you that encouraged you-especially when you are doubting yourself (post it somewhere)

8. Create a Caring Community

- a) Connect daily
- b) b. Identify Your Sources of Support
 - I. Work_____
 - II. Community_____
- c) Practice good communication/conflict resolution skills (Difficult Conversations)

References

- AcpOnline . (n.d.). Resilience . Retrieved from AcpOnline : https://www.acponline.org/system/files/documents/about_acp/chapters/or/resilience_building_plan_worksheet.pdf
- APA. (n.d.). Building your resilience. Retrieved from APA: <https://www.apa.org/topics/resilience>